

Any equipment we provide is on loan and as such should be cared for in accordance with the instructions and returned to the Integrated Community Equipment Loans Store (ICELS) by telephoning the number below.

If you discover any damage, defects or problems operating the equipment then you must report this immediately to

British Red Cross –

Telephone:
0345 127 2911

Email:
customercare@redcross.org.uk



What to do if you are concerned

Please talk to any health and social care professional involved in your care or contact the number below.

Nottinghamshire County Council
Customer Service Centre [0300 500 80 80](tel:03005008080)

Safe Use of Bed Rails in the Community



Tel: 0345 127 2911

Safe Use of Bed Rails

Bed rails are designed to help keep you safe in bed by reducing falls out of bed and injuries. They should not be used to keep you in bed against your free will.

A risk assessment has been carried out by your Health and Social Care professional to assess if this equipment will be of benefit to you.

You will be given a copy of your bed rail risk assessment. It is important that you keep this information safe and available so that every person involved in your care understands your needs.

Your bed, mattress and bed rails have been assessed as compatible with each other to minimise any risks to your safety. None of these parts should be changed without consulting a health and social care professional with specific training in bed rails.

You are advised that it is your responsibility / carers responsibility to regularly check the piece of equipment. Only use it for its intended purpose and do not move it from the original position, to maximize your safety.

Regular Checks –what to look for

All parts of the equipment are in safe working order

The bumpers/padding are in place when in use.

The bed rails are lowered when care is given, so carers do not have to lean over the rails

The rails are always upright and locked when you are on your own.

Check for defects. If you notice anything has become loose, seems to be cracked, worn, or missing, then the bed rail may not be safe to use.

Cleaning

All parts of the equipment can be cleaned with a mild detergent using a cloth. Avoid letting water run inside the tubes.

Using Bed rails

It is important you and your carer/s monitor the use of the equipment and report any of the following changes-

- Changes in the ability of the person using the equipment which may impact on the equipment being used safely.
- If the mattress is changed

- If an additional mattress is placed on top of the existing mattress
- If the equipment moves out of position, resulting in a different gap between the bed rail/bed/mattress
- If there are concerns about any other gaps that could present as an entrapment risk.
- If the bed rails need refitting
- If you are leaning against and can't independently move away from the rails.
- If you have trapped any part of your body in, under or at the side the bed rails
- If you develop new involuntary movements in your arms and legs.
- If you are confused or more confused than usual
- If you have attempted to or considered climbing over the rails
- If you are very frustrated with the rails in place